

Who is driving chaos in L.A.?

Violence flares up during protests, but the real troublemakers may be neither protesters nor police.

By Matthew Ormseth and James Queally

The crowd near Los Angeles City Hall had by Sunday evening reached an uneasy detente with a line of grim-faced police officers. The LAPD officers gripped “less lethal” riot guns, which fire foam rounds that leave red welts and ugly bruises on anyone they hit. Demonstrators massed in downtown Los Angeles for the third straight day. Some were there to protest federal immigration sweeps across the county — others appeared set on wreaking havoc.

Several young men crept through the crowd, hunched over and hiding something in their hands. They reached the front line and hurled eggs at the officers, who fired into the fleeing crowd with riot guns.

Jonas March, who was filming the protests as an independent journalist, dropped to the ground and tried to army-crawl away.

“As soon as I stood up, they shot me in the a—,” the 21-year-old said.

Police Chief Jim McDonnell has drawn a distinction between protesters and masked “anarchists” who, he said, were bent on exploiting the state of unrest to [See [Instigators](#), A10]

Not a ‘war zone’

The Times separates fact from fiction concerning the immigration raids. **PERSPECTIVES, A2**

LAUSD responds

School police will be deployed to shield students and their families from ICE. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Odd TV moment

Presence of Dr. Phil in L.A. should raise alarms, Mary McNamara writes. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times



JASON ARMOND Los Angeles Times

PROTESTERS CONTINUE to clash with the LAPD in downtown L.A. amid federal immigration raids. Some rowdy crowds have vandalized and burglarized buildings, and the Trump administration has deployed troops.

Sending Marines brings peril, questions

By Jenny Jarvie and Grace Toohey

After days of fiery protest against federal immigration raids, Los Angeles residents and officials braced for the arrival of hundreds of U.S. Marines on Tuesday in what some called an unprecedented and potentially explosive deployment of active-duty troops with hazy mission objectives.

As Trump administration officials vowed to crack down on “rioters, looters and thugs,” state local officials decried the mobilization of 700 troops from the Marine Corps Air Ground Combat Center in Twentynine Palms, calling it a clear violation of law and civility. L.A. Mayor Karen Bass even likened the deployment to “an experiment” that nobody asked to be a part of.

According to the U.S. Northern Command, which oversees troops based in the United States, the Marines will join “seamlessly” with National Guard troops under “Task Force 51” — the military’s designation of the Los Angeles forces.

Air Force Gen. Gregory Guillot told The Times on Tuesday that the troops are [See [Marines](#), A9]

Deploying troops trained to fight in overseas conflicts to confront protesters on American soil is cause for concern, military experts say



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

ONE OF the vehicles in the Marine convoy that left the Twentynine Palms base.

Troop arrival adds to local tension

Law enforcement sources say that coordination between police and the feds has been limited.

By Hannah Fry, Rebecca Ellis, Richard Winton, Nathan Solis and Noah Goldberg

U.S. Marines arrived in Los Angeles on Tuesday amid growing concerns about a lack of coordination and communication between local police and the federal forces.

The Trump administration has vowed to send 4,000 National Guard troops and 700 Marines to Los Angeles to protect immigration agents and federal buildings from protests, some of which have turned violent. But there remains something of a mystery about exactly where the forces are being stationed and exactly what they will do.

Local law enforcement sources said coordination between police and the feds has been limited, a distinct contrast to other times troops have hit the streets of L.A. including in 2020 during George Floyd demonstrations and amid the 1992 riots. Such a large federal force has raised eyebrows because most of the clashes have occurred in a relatively small part of downtown Los Angeles as opposed to scattered across the city. L.A. police commanders have at times felt stretched as they deal with rowdy crowds at night that vandalize and steal from buildings, the sources said, but they believe local authorities are much better equipped to bring order than outside forces.

Police stepped up arrests Monday night and sources said officials are considering a nightly curfew in some parts of downtown.

“The possible arrival of federal military forces in Los [See [Protests](#), A8]

‘Cali’ a 4-letter word in Vietnam

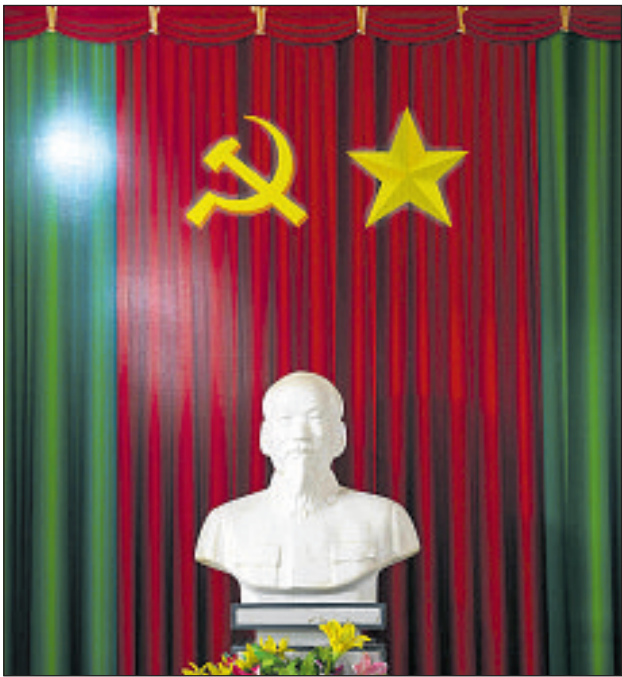
A reference to diaspora in the U.S. becomes a slur amid rising nationalism in Southeast Asian country

By Stephanie Yang

HANOI — Last fall, Vietnam opened a sprawling new military museum here, and among thousands of artifacts in the four-story building and a courtyard filled with tanks and aircraft, one exhibit quickly became the star attraction: the flag of South Vietnam.

The government regards the yellow banner with three red stripes as a sign of resistance to the communist regime, violating laws about inciting dissent. With few exceptions, it is not displayed.

Reactions to the rare sighting soon went viral. Young visitors at the Vietnam Military History Museum posted photos of themselves next to the flag with deep frowns, thumbs down or middle fingers raised. As the photos drew unwanted [See [Vietnam](#), A4]



CHRIS TRIHN For The Times

EVERY public office and school in Vietnam contains either a photo or a figure of founder Ho Chi Minh.

The ‘tremendous heartache’ of being Jewish on campus

In wake of last year’s protests, students and faculty weigh in on Trump’s campaign against antisemitism.

By Daniel Miller

Protesters were chanting slogans Alyssa Wallack had never heard at USC, shouting so loudly that she thought demonstrators were inside the lecture hall where she was attending class.

“Globalize the intifada!” she recalled hearing.

“From the river to the sea ...,” they yelled.

It was Oct. 17, 2023 — 10 days after Hamas launched a terrorist attack against Israel that killed about 1,200 people and took 251 others

as hostages.

Wallack, who is Jewish, said she had to “escape.”

“I freaked out, and I ran out of class and started sobbing,” said Wallack, 23. “It felt like everyone was against me, which I know is not so accurate. But I just remember sitting in my class, not able to learn. ... Were some of the people who I thought were my friends part of these protests, chanting things that were not only offensive but also antisemitic?”

In the months ahead, Wallack said, she didn’t feel safe on campus. She wasn’t alone. Other Jewish students at USC said that after the Hamas attack — and the war it triggered — they too felt unsafe amid pro-Palestinian protests. At UCLA, where a large encampment sparked a violent confrontation [See [Antisemitism](#), A7]

A push to grow wildland access

New bill would expand a Santa Monica Mountains area, but funding cuts could thwart it. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Funk pioneer’s enduring legacy

Music innovator Sly Stone, leader of the group Sly and the Family Stone, dies at 82. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

World Cup plans are complicated

Visa issues amid travel ban hang over preparations for soccer’s big showcase, set to begin in one year. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather
Clearing.
L.A. Basin: 81/61. **B5**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices **A14**

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